

03

Laptop, Desktop and Peripheral Issues

Slow performance, no power, no display, keyboard, mouse, docking and peripherals

Default priority: P3 Medium
(P2 if user cannot work at all)

Target response / resolution: Respond in 15 min / resolve in 4 business hours

Handled by: Tier 1, then Tier 2 /
deskside

Scope

Use this instruction for hardware faults and performance problems on company-issued computers and their peripherals.

Related instructions: WI-18 Asset Management, WI-19 OS Updates and Patching, WI-10 Security Incidents

Common symptoms

- Device will not power on, boots to a black screen, or restarts unexpectedly
- Very slow performance, freezing, or overheating
- Keyboard, mouse, webcam, headset, or docking station not working
- Blue screen errors, disk full warnings, or battery not charging

Information to collect

- Asset tag or hostname, make and model
- Exact symptoms, error text, and when it started
- Any recent changes (updates, new software, drops or spills)
- Whether the problem follows the user to another device or dock

Resolution steps

- 1 Check the basics.** Confirm the charger is connected and the outlet works, cables are firm, and the device is not in sleep or airplane mode. Hold the power button for 15 seconds, then try again.
- 2 Isolate the fault.** Disconnect all peripherals and test with a known-good charger, dock, or mouse. This separates a peripheral problem from a device problem.
- 3 Review system health.** Remotely check CPU, memory, and disk usage, pending updates, uptime, and event logs. Restart if uptime is over 7 days.
- 4 Clear common causes.** Free disk space, remove unneeded start-up items, run the manufacturer diagnostics, and install pending operating system and driver updates.
- 5 Back up user data.** Before any repair or rebuild, confirm user data is synced to cloud storage or backed up. Do not reimage without confirmation from the user.
- 6 Repair or replace.** If hardware has failed, log a warranty claim with the vendor or issue a loaner device from stock. Record the serial numbers of both devices.
- 7 Verify with the user.** Confirm the user can sign in and open their key applications. Collect any returned faulty hardware and update the asset register.

Escalate when

- Suspected physical damage, liquid exposure, or battery swelling (tell the user to power off and stop charging)
- Repeated crashes after a rebuild, suggesting a hardware fault
- Lost or stolen device: raise a security incident immediately (see WI-10)

Resolution and closure

- Record the root cause (hardware, software, user error) and the fix
- Update the asset register for any swap, repair, or loaner
- Close after the user confirms the issue is resolved

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Device will not power on	Flat battery, faulty charger, or power fault	Try a known-good charger and outlet. Hold the power button 15 seconds. If no sign of life, arrange a loaner.
Very slow performance	Low disk space, high memory use, or pending updates	Check resource usage remotely, clear space, apply updates, and restart.
Black screen but device is on	Display cable, dock, or graphics driver	Try an external monitor, disconnect the dock, and update the graphics driver.
Keyboard or mouse not responding	Dead battery, receiver issue, or driver	Replace batteries, re-pair or change the USB port, and try a spare device.
Blue screen errors	Driver conflict, failing memory, or disk errors	Record the stop code, boot to safe mode, run diagnostics, and escalate if repeated.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	"I am sorry the laptop is giving you trouble. Can you tell me exactly what you see on the screen?"
During	"I am going to check a few things remotely. It will take about ten minutes, and I will tell you before I restart anything."
Close	"The device is working again. If it freezes or shows the same error, please call us and quote this ticket number."

Good practice

Do

- Check that data is backed up before a rebuild
- Test with known-good cables and peripherals
- Record the stop code or error text
- Issue a loaner when repair will take more than a few hours

Do not

- Do not reimage without the user's confirmation
- Do not open a device that is under warranty
- Do not ignore battery swelling or overheating (treat as a safety issue)
- Do not forget to update the asset register after a swap

Worked example

A user's laptop freezes several times a day and has become very slow after a recent update.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Laptop freezes, slow for two weeks.
Checks performed	Disk is 97 percent full. Pending updates for three weeks. Uptime 24 days.
Cause	Low disk space and missed restarts.
Action taken	Cleared temporary files, moved large files to cloud storage, installed updates, restarted.
Result	Performance normal. Closed after the user confirmed.

Frequently asked questions

Q. When should a device be replaced rather than repaired?

Replace when the repair cost is high compared with the device value, when it is beyond its refresh age, or when repeated failures stop the user from working. Check warranty first.

Q. How do we handle a user who needs a device back the same day?

Issue a pre-built loaner, move the user's data through cloud sync, and repair the original afterwards. Record both asset tags.

Q. Is a spilled-liquid laptop safe to turn on?

No. Tell the user to power it off, unplug it, and not to charge it. Collect it for inspection and use a loaner in the meantime.

Analyst checklist

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Check the basics | ☐ Repair or replace |
| ☐ Isolate the fault | ☐ Verify with the user |
| ☐ Review system health | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Clear common causes | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Back up user data | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Schedule a monthly reminder to restart
- Monitor disk space and alert at 85 percent
- Replace laptops at the end of the lifecycle
- Provide spare docks and cables in the IT cabinet